42 AGENCY PLAYBOOK

Lead Scoring Framework Builder

Build an ICP-Based Model That Predicts Conversion

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Why Most Lead Scoring Fails

Most lead scoring models are built backwards. Teams assign arbitrary points to actions (downloaded whitepaper = 10 points!) without validating against actual conversion data.

The result: Sales gets "MQLs" that don't convert, loses trust in marketing, and the model becomes ignored.

> **The Fix:**
>
> Build your scoring model from *closed-won analysis*, not guesswork. What do your best customers have in common? What actions did they take before converting?

The Two-Axis Scoring Model

Effective lead scoring has two independent components:

Axis	What It Measures	Max Points
ICP Fit Score	How well does this lead match your ideal customer profile?	50 points
Engagement Score	How actively is this lead engaging with your content/product?	50 points

Why two axes? A perfect-fit company with no engagement isn't ready for sales. A highly engaged lead from a bad-fit company will waste sales time. You need *both* to be high.

ICP Fit Scoring (50 points max)

Score these firmographic and demographic attributes:

Attribute	Ideal Match	Points
Company Size	Your sweet spot (e.g., 200-2000 employees)	+15
	Adjacent (e.g., 50-199 or 2001-5000)	+8
	Outside range	0
Industry	Primary target industry	+15
	Secondary industry	+8
	Non-target	0
Job Title/Seniority	Decision maker (VP+)	+10
	Influencer (Manager/Director)	+6
	Individual contributor	+2
Geography	Primary market	+5
	Secondary market	+2
Tech Stack	Uses complementary tech	+5

Engagement Scoring (50 points max)

Score behavioral signals by intent strength:

Action	Intent Level	Points
Demo/Trial Request	High	+25
Pricing Page Visit	High	+15
Case Study Download	High	+10
Product Page (2+ visits)	Medium	+8
Webinar Attendance	Medium	+8
Whitepaper/Guide Download	Medium	+5
Blog Visit (3+ articles)	Low	+3
Email Click	Low	+2
Email Open	Low	+1

Important:

Cap engagement score contributions from low-intent actions. Someone who opens 50 emails shouldn't outscore someone who requested a demo.

Score Decay: The Missing Piece

Engagement scores should decay over time. A demo request from 6 months ago isn't as valuable as one from last week.

Recommended Decay Schedule

Time Since Action	Score Retention
0-30 days	100%
31-60 days	75%
61-90 days	50%
90+ days	25%

Implementation: Most MAPs support score decay. In HubSpot, use a workflow that reduces engagement score by 25% every 30 days if no new activity.

MQL Threshold Calibration

Your MQL threshold should be calibrated against actual conversion data, not arbitrary numbers.

Calibration Process

1. Apply your scoring model retroactively to the last 6-12 months of leads
2. Segment by score ranges (0-25, 26-50, 51-75, 76-100)
3. Calculate conversion rate to SQL and closed-won for each segment
4. Set MQL threshold where conversion rate becomes acceptable to sales

> **Example:**
> If leads scoring 60+ convert to SQL at 25% (vs 5% for leads under 60), set your MQL threshold at 60. Review and adjust quarterly.